

Lincolnshire Knee Clinic

Consultant-Led Specialist Knee Care

Wound Care & Scar Guidelines

Important instructions for postoperative incision care

Wound Care (Days 1 - 14)

- Keep the dressing clean and dry. Avoid submerging the wound in water.
- Do not remove the adhesive dressing unless advised by your clinical team.
- Surgical clips or sutures are typically removed 10-14 days postoperatively.
- Shower with a waterproof cover over the dressing as instructed.

Signs of Infection (Contact Clinic Immediately)

- Increased redness, swelling, or warmth around the incision.
- New or foul-smelling discharge/pus from the wound.
- A body temperature above 38°C (100.4°F) or persistent chills.
- Sudden, severe increase in knee pain not relieved by medication.

Scar Management (From Week 3 Onward)

- Ensure the wound is completely healed and dry before starting massage.
- Apply a small amount of simple, non-perfumed moisturising cream or oil.
- Use firm, circular motions along and across the scar line for 5-10 minutes daily.
- Avoid direct sun exposure on the healing scar for the first 12 months (use SPF 50).